
MEETING MINUTES

The Eleventh Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

June 3, 2024

Executive Session 5:00 p.m.

Regular Meeting: 6:00 p.m.

Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - **6/1**
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Executive Session

Executive session pursuant to G.L. c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to update on negotiations with **Medford Educational Secretaries (AFSCME Council 93), Medford Teachers Association for Kids Corner, Medford Teachers Association for Paraprofessionals** because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Executive session pursuant to G.L. c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to discuss collective bargaining with the MTA regarding a grievance dated March, 2024.

Motion to enter into Executive Session by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 6/1

5:07 pm

6:45 pm resumed regular meeting - 7/0 attendance at this time

- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Approval of Capital Purchases
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **May 20, 2024**
 - Strategic and Capital Planning Subcommittee Minutes, **May 21, 2024**
 - Curriculum Instruction, Assessment and Accountability Subcommittee, **May 28, 2024**

Motion to Approve by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Olapade - 7/0

- V. Report of Subcommittees
 - **Strategic and Capital Planning Subcommittee**, Meeting held on May 21, 2024

Update provided by Member Graham

- **Curriculum Instruction, Assessment and Accountability Subcommittee**, Meeting held on May 28, 2024

Updated provided by Member Reinfeld

VI. Report of the Superintendent

1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. **Fine Arts Student Recognition** - Suzanne Fee, Coordinator of Fine Arts
3. **Announcement of New Positions** - New Principal of the Missituk Elementary School, Mrs. Nancy Sherman-Hudson and the New Director of Kids Corner, Mrs. Cristina Lungo-Dudley - by Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
4. **Blumsack Leadership Awards** - Stacey Schulman, Director of School Counseling and Behavioral Health
5. **McGlynn Playground Update** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent
 - Donations are still being accepted with gratitude.
6. **Student Opportunity Act Update** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent

Motion to approve the plan by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passed

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) - None

VII. Continued Business

- **MSBA / MCHSBC Update** (*tabled from May 20, 2024*) - Presented by Jenny Graham, Chair
 1. School Building Committee Meeting, May 13, 2024

VIII. New Business

Resolution read in it's entirety by Member Ruseau

2024-28 Offered by Member Ruseau

DBC - BUDGET PREPARATION AND SCHEDULE

Preparation of the annual budget will be scheduled in phases with attention to specific deadlines. This policy aims to increase transparency into how the Public Schools budget is developed, to ensure the School Committee is appropriately involved in budget development, and to increase public participation and understanding of how their tax dollars are spent educating the children of our great city.

Phase I - Planning

Target Dates: October 1 to December 15

1. Enrollment projections;
2. Staffing, current and required; recommended policy changes;

3. Expenditure projections of the costs of this year's operation at next year's estimated prices, adjusted for enrollment changes and other cost information;
4. Revenue projections, including "best estimates" of federal, state, and grant funds;
5. Facilities information, especially projected surpluses and deficits in classroom space and future needs for repairs;
6. Cost Effectiveness and other special studies of designated programs, activities, and policies;
7. Draft of the basic school allocation rates and factors and any proposed changes.

Phase II - Budget Request Formulation

Target dates: December 15 to February 1

Within the framework outlined in Phase I, the budget is formulated as follows:

1. Issue budget manual for next fiscal year, procedures, and forms, including school allocation and factors, and conduct orientation;
2. Principals discuss budget needs with school councils and provide feedback to the Superintendent;
3. Conduct School Committee Committee of the Whole meetings, with public input, to discuss priorities and possible initiatives;
4. Conduct administrative review of budget requests, including discussion with principals;
5. Inclusion of Net School Spending eligible portions of the Capital Improvement Plan.
6. Develop the proposed budget for the Medford Public Schools;
7. Submit the proposed budget to the School Committee for its review.

Phase III - School Committee Review and Approval of Budget Request

Target Dates: February 1 to February 28

The budget is presented to the School Committee for its review and for public testimony.

1. Budget presentation by the Superintendent;
2. Public hearing(s) will be scheduled pursuant to MGL ch17 s38N;
3. School Committee's budget decision meeting(s);
4. Final School Committee decision and approval for submission to the City Council.

Phase IV - Superintendent and School Committee Receive Projected Municipal Allocation

Target Date: March 1

1. The Municipal leadership will notify the Superintendent and the School Committee in writing of the Projected Municipal Allocation.

Phase V - Proposed Reconciled Budget Developed in Response to Projected Municipal Allocation

Target Date: March 1 - May 1

The Proposed Reconciled Budget, including all required cuts to meet the Projected Municipal Allocation, is presented to the School Committee for review and public testimony.

1. If the Projected Municipal Allocation is less than the Budget Request:
 - a. The Superintendent will develop a Projected Municipal Budget with cuts to meet the Projected Municipal Allocation;

- b. The Proposed Reconciled Budget reflecting cuts required to meet the Proposed Reconciled Budget will be made available to the School Committee and the public;
- c. If the Proposed Municipal Allocation is more than 1% less than the Budget Request, a public hearing will be scheduled pursuant to MGL ch17 s38N;

Phase VI - School Committee Transmission to City Government

Target Date: May 15

1. The School Committee Budget Request and presentation will be forwarded to the Mayor and City Council.
2. The Proposed Reconciled Budget in response to Projected Municipal Allocation will be forwarded to the Mayor and City Council.
3. A cover letter written by the School Committee will be included with the above-named documents.

Phase VII - City Council Review and Approval

Target Date: May 15 - June 30

The City Council approves the municipal budget with the final allocation for Medford Public Schools.

1. Review and approval by the City Council.

Phase VIII - School Committee Review and Approval of Final Budget

Target Date: June 1 - June 30

The School Committee finalizes a budget for the upcoming fiscal year.

1. Municipal Allocation received from the City Council;
2. If the Municipal Allocation is the same as the Budget Request, the School Committee will meet to provide approval for the Final Budget;
3. If the Municipal Allocation is less than the Budget Request:
 - a. The Superintendent will provide any updates to the Proposed Reconciled Budget presented in Phase V.
 - b. The updated Proposed Reconciled Budget reflecting the recommended cuts will be made available to the School Committee and the public;
 - c. If the Municipal Allocation is more than 1% less than the Budget Request, a public hearing will be scheduled pursuant to MGL ch17 s38N;
 - d. If a public hearing is required, a Regular or Special School Committee Meeting to approve the Proposed Reconciled Budget will be scheduled no less than five business days after the public hearing;
 - e. If a public hearing is not required, a Regular or Special School Committee Meeting will be scheduled to approve the Proposed Reconciled Budget.
4. The Final Budget will be posted on the Medford Public Schools website.

Motion to waive reading of definitions by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham 7/0

Definitions:

Budget Request - the Superintendent's budget, based on what is required to meet the needs of all students of Medford Public Schools.

Capital Improvement Plan (CIP) - A capital improvement plan typically consists of one or more capital improvement projects, which are financed through a capital budget. CIPs are important tools for local governments, allowing them to plan strategically for community growth and transformation.

Capital Improvement Projects (Capital Projects) - asset upgrades or large-scale maintenance work. Some examples of capital projects include building a new school, replacing an outdated HVAC system, replacing a roof, or any project above \$150,000 per school building.

Capital Budget - contains the funds allocated for all capital projects in a fiscal year. The city typically holds this account in a stabilization fund, although school districts may create their own stabilization fund to cover such expenses. Regardless of where the fund is held, the resources in the fund are provided by the municipality and are *not* part of the budget of the public schools.

Final Budget - the School Committee approved budget for operating the Medford Public Schools.

Municipal Allocation - the financial resources the City of Medford has allocated to the Medford Public Schools for the education of the children of the City of Medford.

Net School Spending - all funds expended by the School Committee via the budget, grants, and other funds, as well as certain city expenditures such as insurance and pensions, excluding certain types of expenditures such as transportation, adult education, and long-term debt.

Projected Municipal Allocation - the financial resources the City of Medford *believes* it will be able to provide to the public schools. This occurs early in the annual budget process and is likely to change as municipal, state, and federal resources become clearer. This is required by

Proposed Reconciled Budget - the Superintendent's recommended budget that reflects the Proposed Municipal Allocation or the approved Municipal Allocation. A Reconciled Budget is assumed to be less than what is required to meet the needs of all Medford Public Schools students.

Policy Information

First Adopted: TBD

Last Amended: None

Last Reviewed: None

Review Frequency: two (2) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 1

Policy ID: DBC

Related Policies: DCA - Capital Improvement Planning

Original Source: MASC - Updated 2022

Legal References: M.G.L. [71:38N](#)

Date Requested: May 28, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: June 3, 2024

- Superintendent would like to unpack the timing of Phase I and Phase II with her team.
- Member Ruseau explained it's flexible according to school schedules so long as the end date is met.
- Member Graham expressed her support of the timeline and would like an earlier overall budget timeline to avoid the end of year rush with budget discussions along with other topics.

Motion to amend DBC by Member Graham, second by Member Ruseau as follows:

Phase V.1.b will be amended to say, "The Proposed Reconciled Budget reflecting cuts required to meet the Projected Municipal Allocation will be made available to the School Committee and the public;"

Phase VIII.3.d will be amended to say, "If a public hearing is required, a Regular or Special School Committee Meeting will be scheduled no less than five business days after the City budget has been approved to approve the Proposed Reconciled Budget."

Phase II.2 will be amended to add "directors, and department heads" after "principals".

Motion passes as amended - 7/0

NEW DBC as amended

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IX. Reports Requested - None

X. Condolences - None

XI. Next Meeting

- **June 10, 2024** held at Alden Memorial Chambers in addition to zoom. This will be the last regular meeting of the Medford School Committee for SY 23-24.

XII. Adjournment

Motion to Adjourn by Member Branley, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0

Meeting adjourned at 8:11 p.m.